

Government extends M-SIPS by five years

The government has extended the special incentive package for electronic manufacturing in India by five years, a move aimed at giving a boost to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Make in India campaign.

The package, called M-SIPS (modified special incentive package scheme), has been sweetened by including 15 new product categories to the list. Smartcards, liquid crystal modules, consumer appliances such as refrigerators, ACs, microwaves and optical fibre are some new categories.

The package subsidises capex by 20 per cent for investments in SEZs and 25 per cent for projects outside SEZs. It also provides for countervailing duties/excise for capital equipment for non-SEZ units.

Further, reimbursement of central taxes and duties is provided for high technology and high capital investment units. The government has now made it easier to receive benefits, with disbursement of incentives on happening on a quarterly basis as against annually earlier. It has also extended M-SIPS for units located in any part of the country. The incentives will now be allowed from the date of submission of application.

Maharashtra traders with turnover below ₹ 500 million exempt from paying LBT

With effect from August 1, 2015, Maharashtra government has exempted traders with a turnover of less than ₹ 500 million from paying Local Body Tax (LBT) to any of the 25 municipal councils.

The government has made a budget provision of about ₹ 20 billion to compensate the municipal corporations. The exemption will benefit 808,391 traders out of a total 809,553 registered ones.

In Focus

Appointments at Accenture in India

Accenture has announced that Rekha M. Menon will be chairman of Accenture and Anindya Basu will be country MD, both in India. These appointments are effective August 21, 2015.

Ravinder Zutshi joins Optiemus Infracore as MD

Ravinder Zutshi, who was deputy MD at Samsung India till December last year, has joined smartphone distribution firm Optiemus Infracore as managing director.

YV Verma Joins Videocon as consultant

YV Verma, who was director for home appliances business at LG India till two years ago, has joined Videocon as a

part-time consultant to help fine-tune the company's human resource strategy.

Canon India promotes Andrew Koh as VP

Canon India has promoted Andrew Koh to the post of VP for its Consumer Imaging and Information Centre. Koh has spent 18 years with Canon and was senior director of Image Communication Products Centre for camera products.

Qualcomm appoints Sunil Lalvani as India head

Qualcomm Inc. has appointed former BlackBerry India head, Sunil Lalvani, as VP and president of Qualcomm India, as Avneesh Agrawal, senior VP and president of Qualcomm India and South Asia exits the company.

Consumer electronics industry to hit US\$ 20.6 billion by 2020

India's appliance and consumer electronics sector is set to grow at a compound annual rate of 13.4 per cent to touch US\$ 20.6 billion by 2020, according to the report that was released jointly by EY and Consumer Electronics and Appliances Manufacturers Association (CEAMA).

The report also mentioned that the market was worth US\$ 9.7 billion in 2014, and the annual growth rate was 9.7 per cent. Within consumer electronics, set-top boxes are seen as the fastest growing category, at 28.8 per cent year-on-year, primarily because of the government's digitisation initiative.

From just 18.4 million units in 2012, the set-top box category is expected to reach 39.4 million in 2015, while there will be about 45 million units of replacements over the next four years as India gets digitised.

The television category is projected to grow at 20 per cent year-on-year between 2014 and 2020, followed by

refrigerators at 10 per cent, washing machines at eight per cent to nine percent and air-conditioners at around six per cent to seven per cent.

India to emerge as No. 3 in creative imaging field

According to Nikon India MD, Kazuo Ninomiya, India is expected to emerge as the world's third largest in terms of revenue generation in the field of creative imaging over the next five years. About five years ago, India was ranked 15th in the world in this sector.

Ninomiya was speaking in the steel city to launch the first COOLPIX zone here. He was accompanied by vice president (imaging division) of Nikon India, Sajjan Kumar.

He also said that the company is looking at 30 per cent to 50 per cent growth in its turnover in the next five years.

CeBIT ties up with CLIK to boost ESDM sector in Karnataka

CeBIT India 2015, organised by Hannover Milano Fairs India Pvt